READING PART 1

Gapped email

Task Overview

In Part 1, you complete a short **message** or **email** by choosing one word for each gap. Each gap has three options (A, B or C). This is the easiest of the four reading tasks.

Key points:

- There are **5 questions** (5 marks).
- Each gap has **3 options**
- The first gap is done for you as an example.
- You need both **correct meaning** and **correct grammar**.

General strategy

- Read the whole text quickly first: who is writing, why, and what's happening?
- For each gap, predict the **type of word** (verb / preposition / linker / adjective, etc.).
- Check the words before and after the gap (collocations, tense, prepositions).
- **Eliminate** options that don't fit **grammatically**, then choose the best meaning.

In this chapter, you will:

- practise predicting the word type needed in each gap
- learn quick elimination strategies
- complete extra practice tasks

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Guided Reading Tasks

Step 1: Prediction

In the following tasks, you will look at examples of part 1 without the options. Try to predict the **type of word** (noun / verb etc) that is needed and **possible answers**.

Task 1: Party invitation

Read the email from Jane to her friend. Choose one word from the three options for each gap. The first one is done for you.

Hi Sam,
I'd like to **(0) invite** you to my birthday dinner.
It's **(1)** ___ Saturday evening at 8.
Can you **(2)** ___ a dessert, if you have time?
We already have **(3)** ___drinks.
I can't cook everything, **(4)** ___ help would be great.
The restaurant is **(5)** ___ to the metro station.
Best,
Jane

For example: 1) We need a preposition. Which do we use with Saturday evening?
4) We need a linker. What is the connection between the two phrases?

Task 2: Shopping note

Read the email from Sophie to her mum. Choose one word from the three options for each gap. The first one is done for you.

Hi Mum,
Can you **(0) buy** some bread on your way home?
We need it for **(1)** ___ week's lunches.
It's a **(2)** ___ day, so maybe we can eat outside.
I'm **(3)** ___ work early today.
Don't forget your **(4)** ___! It might rain later.
I'll be home **(5)** ___ 5:30.
Love,
Sophie

Predictions!

- What type of word do you need in the gap? A preposition, a verb, and -ing form?
- Can you think of at least one option that would fit?
- Make sure your options fit both **grammatically** and in **meaning**

Step 2: Multiple-choice options

Now look at the options for both tasks.

- Which of the options fits best in the gap?
- Why are the other two options incorrect?
- Did you predict any of the answers correctly?

Task 1: Party invitation

0:	A: invite	B: invent	C: involve
1:	A: at	B: on	C: in
2:	A: bring	B: take	C: carry
3:	A: any	B: some	C: much
4:	A: because	B: so	C: such
5:	A: near	B: between	C: close

Task 2: Shopping note

0:	A: bring	B: buy	C: pick
1:	A: first	B: following	C: next
2:	A: cold	B: sun	C: warm
3:	A: leaving	B: arriving	C: finish
4:	A: umbrella	B: wallet	C: keys
5:	A: exactly	B: around	C: near

Final tips

- Most of these questions will be relatively easy — but you still get **5** points out of **25** total. So be sure to read the text carefully.
- Be careful, but be **fast**! You only have 35 minutes for the complete test, and you want to keep most of it for the longer sections.
- Play close attention to the words **before** and **after** the gap before answering.

Practice Reading Tasks

Now try two more tasks using the same strategies we've just practised!

Task 1: Reservation

Read the email from Lisa to her friend. Choose one word from the three options for each gap. The first one is done for you.

Hi David,
How's it **(0) going**?
Can you **(1)** ___ a table for us at the Italian restaurant tonight?
Please call **(2)** ___ 6 pm because they get busy.
Don't **(3)** ___ to ask for a table by the window.
The restaurant **(4)** ___ at 11 pm.
I'll meet you outside your **(5)** ___ at 7:30.
Lisa

0:	A: going	B: go	C: been
1:	A: book	B: buy	C: make
2:	A: after	B: until	C: before
3:	A: forget	B: remind	C: worry
4:	A: opens	B: shuts	C: sets up
5:	A: kitchen	B: office	C: desk

Task 2: Work email

Read the email from Sophie to her mum. Choose one word from the three options for each gap. The first one is done for you.

Dear Maria,
Could you **(0) send** me the notes from yesterday's meeting?
Is the next meeting in the **(1)** ___ room?
I don't **(2)** ___ the date for it.
Please call me **(3)** ___ lunch if you can.
I'll be studying in the **(4)** ___ this afternoon.
I **(5)** ___ to finish this report by Friday.
Ben

0:	A: send	B: receive	C: make
1:	A: similar	B: alike	C: same
2:	A: recall	B: remind	C: write
3:	A: while	B: when	C: before
4:	A: cinema	B: metro	C: library
5:	A: must	B: need	C: should

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